Nexchip (688249.SS): 4Q26 guidance meet seasonality, 3Q26 OP income better than expected; Neutral

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4Q26 guidance meet seasonality: Nexchip guides (link) 4Q26 revenues at Rmb3.2bn to Rmb3.4bn, or midpoint at Rmb3.3bn (-2% QoQ, 20% YoY), which is largely in line with last year seasonality (4Q25 revenues declined by 6% QoQ), leading to 2026 revenues to Rmb13bn, or +16% YoY, similar to 2025 revenues growth of 18% YoY. 4Q26 GM is guided at 20-24%, also similar to last year seasonality, that is slightly lower than 3Q GM. The company continues steadily capacity expansion and product mix upgrade toward more advanced nodes and AI related application (e.g. power supply semis), while its exposure to consumer electronics (e.g. DDIC, CIS) could weigh on its growth under high memory costs. Maintain Neutral.

3Q26 OP income beat: Revenue was Rmb3.4bn (+14% YoY / +10% QoQ), 1% higher than GSe. GM was 26.4%, 2.5ppt higher than GSe, along with better than expected opex ratio at 14.2% (vs. 16.8% of GSe), driving operating income 75% higher than GSe at Rmb408mn. However, pre-tax income was 3% lower than GSe, mainly due to a Rmb64mn fair-value loss and a Rmb79mn FX loss. Net income was Rmb229mn (+5% YoY / +18% QoQ), 10% higher than GSe. The GM beat reflects disciplined capacity expansion, high utilization rate, and product mix upgrade.

Exhibit 1: Nexchip: 3Q26 results snapshot

Rmb mn	3Q25	2Q26	3Q26	YoY	QoQ	GS	Act / GS
Revenue	2,931	3,045	3,354	14%	10%	3,306	1%
GP	766	673	885	16%	32%	790	12%
OP	246	210	408	66%	94%	234	75%
Pre-tax income	163	207	210	28%	1%	216	-3%
Net income	218	195	229	5%	18%	209	10%
Margins							
GPM	26.1%	22.1%	26.4%			23.9%	2.5 ppts
OPM	8.4%	6.9%	12.2%			7.1%	5.1 ppts
NPM	7.4%	6.4%	6.8%			6.3%	0.5 ppts

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Earnings revisions: We factor in Nexchip's 3Q26 results and 4Q26 guidance and revise down our 2026E-28E net income estimates by 15% / 1% / 8%. We lower our 2026E-28E revenue estimates by 6% / 8% / 6%, mainly on lower 4Q26 revenue assumptions and a more gradual shipment ramp from new capacity. We lower our 2026E-28E GM estimates by 0.1ppt / 0.9ppt / 1.5ppt, reflecting the 4Q26 GM guidance, and higher depreciation during the new-capacity ramp. We lower our 2026E-28E opex ratio estimates by 0.9ppt / 1.8ppt / 1.2ppt, reflecting the better than expected opex ratio in 3Q26. Together with the lower revenue and GM assumptions, partially offset by the lower opex ratio estimates, our 2026E-28E net income estimates are revised down by 15% / 1% / 8%.

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Exhibit 2: Earnings revisions

	2026E			2027E			2028E		
Rmb mn	Old	New	Chg	Old	New	Chg	Old	New	Chg
Revenue	13,512	12,716	-6%	17,401	15,976	-8%	20,636	19,307	-6%
GP	3,233	3,032	-6%	5,106	4,541	-11%	6,663	5,935	-11%
OP	1,126	1,165	4%	2,263	2,224	-2%	3,361	3,078	-8%
Net income	1,006	855	-15%	1,918	1,902	-1%	3,101	2,848	-8%
Margins									
GM	23.9%	23.8%	-0.1%	29.3%	28.4%	-0.9%	32.3%	30.7%	-1.5%
OPM	8.3%	9.2%	0.8%	13.0%	13.9%	0.9%	16.3%	15.9%	-0.3%
NM	7.4%	6.7%	-0.7%	11.0%	11.9%	0.9%	15.0%	14.8%	-0.3%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

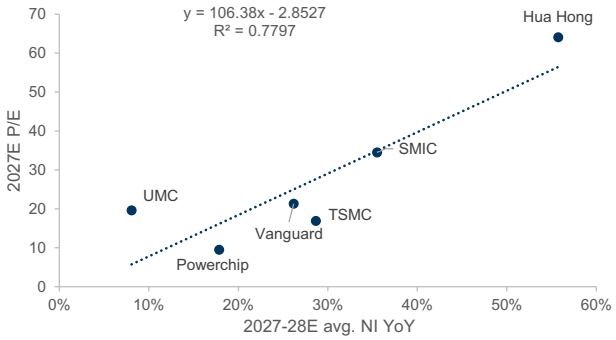
Exhibit 3: Nexchip P&L

Rmb m	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26E	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenues	2,568	2,631	2,931	2,756	2,912	3,045	3,354	3,405	10,051	7,244	9,249	10,885	12,716	15,976	19,307
GP	700	640	766	673	619	673	885	856	4,639	1,565	2,359	2,778	3,032	4,541	5,935
OP	249	165	246	158	170	210	408	377	3,404	155	647	818	1,165	2,224	3,078
Pretax income	86	146	163	71	29	207	210	372	3,156	119	482	467	817	1,993	2,993
Net income	135	197	218	154	51	195	229	380	3,045	212	533	704	855	1,902	2,848
EPS (Rmb)	0.07	0.10	0.11	0.08	0.03	0.10	0.10	0.17	2.02	0.11	0.27	0.35	0.40	0.85	1.27
Margins															
GM	27.2%	24.3%	26.1%	24.4%	21.3%	22.1%	26.4%	25.1%	46.2%	21.6%	25.5%	25.5%	23.8%	28.4%	30.7%
OPM	9.7%	6.3%	8.4%	5.7%	5.8%	6.9%	12.2%	11.1%	33.9%	2.1%	7.0%	7.5%	9.2%	13.9%	15.9%
NM	5.3%	7.5%	7.4%	5.6%	1.7%	6.4%	6.8%	11.2%	30.3%	2.9%	5.8%	6.5%	6.7%	11.9%	14.8%
Ratios															
S&M ratio	0.6%	0.6%	0.6%	0.6%	0.6%	0.6%	0.6%	0.6%	0.6%	0.7%	0.6%	0.6%	0.6%	0.6%	0.6%
G&A ratio	3.0%	3.0%	3.0%	3.0%	3.0%	3.0%	3.0%	3.5%	2.9%	3.7%	3.7%	3.7%	3.7%	3.0%	2.8%
R&D ratio	13.2%	13.6%	13.1%	13.6%	10.4%	10.1%	9.6%	9.6%	8.5%	14.6%	13.9%	13.4%	9.9%	10.5%	11.0%
Opex ratio	17.6%	18.0%	17.7%	18.7%	15.4%	15.2%	14.2%	14.0%	12.3%	19.5%	18.5%	18.0%	14.7%	14.5%	14.8%
YoY															
Revenues	15%	21%	23%	11%	13%	16%	14%	24%	85%	-28%	28%	18%	17%	26%	21%
GP	26%	24%	20%	4%	-12%	5%	16%	27%	89%	-66%	51%	18%	9%	50%	31%
OP	62%	68%	15%	-13%	-32%	27%	66%	139%	95%	-95%	319%	26%	42%	91%	38%
Net income	71%	83%	137%	-39%	-63%	-1%	5%	147%	76%	-93%	152%	32%	21%	122%	50%
QoQ															
Revenues	4%	2%	11%	-6%	6%	5%	10%	2%							
GP	8%	-9%	20%	-12%	-8%	9%	32%	-3%							
OP	37%	-34%	49%	-36%	7%	24%	94%	-7%							
Net income	-47%	45%	11%	-29%	-67%	284%	18%	66%							

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation: We continue to use 2030E discounted P/E to derive our target price (methodology unchanged). Our 12-month target price is revised down to Rmb44.0 from Rmb51.4 previously. Our target P/E multiple is derived from peers' correlation of forward-year trading P/E and NI growth, and is lowered to 24.5x from 24.9x. We apply the 24.5x target P/E to our 2030E EPS estimate and discount it back to 2027E with an unchanged COE of 9%. We maintain Neutral on a coverage-relative basis as we see higher upside elsewhere in our coverage.

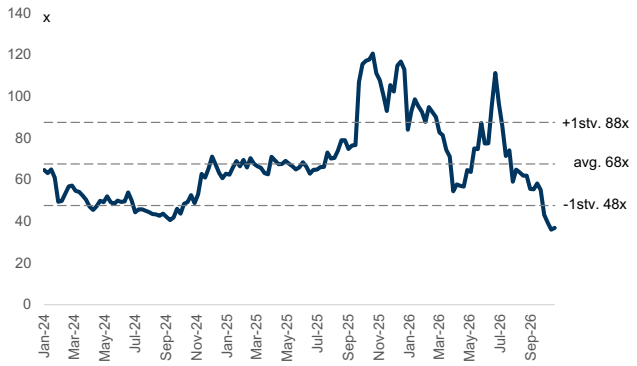
Exhibit 4: Peers' correlation of forward year trading P/E and net income growth



Refinitive Eikon consensus for UMC, Vanguard, and Powerchip

Source: Company data, Refinitiv Eikon, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: Nexchip 12M forward P/E



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Eikon Datastream

Exhibit 6: Nexchip discounted P/E

Rmb mn	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2031E
Revenue	**7,244**	**9,249**	**10,885**	**12,716**	**15,976**	**19,307**	**22,203**	**25,534**	**29,236**
Rev YoY %	*-28%*	*28%*	*18%*	*17%*	*26%*	*21%*	*15%*	*15%*	*15%*
Gross margin	21.6%	25.5%	25.5%	23.8%	28.4%	30.7%	33.3%	34.3%	35.0%
Gross profit	1,565	2,359	2,778	3,032	4,541	5,935	7,394	8,758	10,233
Opex	**1,411**	**1,712**	**1,960**	**1,867**	**2,316**	**2,857**	**3,108**	**3,319**	**3,508**
Opex ratio	19%	19%	18%	15%	15%	15%	14%	13%	12%
OP income	**155**	**647**	**818**	**1,165**	**2,224**	**3,078**	**4,285**	**5,439**	**6,724**
OPM	*2%*	*7%*	*8%*	*9%*	*14%*	*16%*	*19%*	*21%*	*23%*
Non-op gains	(35)	(165)	(351)	(348)	(231)	(85)	(85)	(85)	(85)
Pre-tax profit	**119**	**482**	**467**	**817**	**1,993**	**2,993**	**4,200**	**5,354**	**6,639**
Tax expense	0	0	0	5	100	153	214	273	339
Minority interest	(92)	(51)	(238)	(43)	(8)	(8)	(8)	(8)	(8)
Net profit	**212**	**533**	**704**	**855**	**1,902**	**2,848**	**3,986**	**5,081**	**6,301**
YoY	-93%	152%	32%	21%	122%	50%	40%	27%	24%
EPS	0.11	0.27	0.35	0.40	0.85	1.27	1.78	2.27	2.82
2030 Target P/E								24.5x	
12M target price (Rmb)					**44.0**				
TP implied P/E					**52**	**35**	**25**		

COE assumption	
Beta	0.90
Risk free	3.5%
Market risk premium	6.5%
COE	**9%**

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Nexchip

Valuation: We are Neutral-rated on Nexchip with a 12-month target price of Rmb44.0, which is based on 24.5x 2030E discounted P/E (discounted back to 2027E). Our target P/E is derived from peers' correlation of forward year trading P/E and NI growth.

Key Risks: Slower-/faster-than-expected capacity expansion; weaker-/stronger-than-expected demand in DDIC and CIS; slower-/faster-than-expected R&D; more/less intense competition than expected.

688249.SS	12m Price Target: **Rmb44.00**	Price: **Rmb26.74**	Upside: **64.5%**

Neutral

Market cap: Rmb57.9bn / $8.7bn
Enterprise value: Rmb79.4bn / $11.9bn
3m ADTV: Rmb752.9mn / $111.9mn
China Greater China Technology M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (Rmb mn) New	**10,885.4**	**12,715.8**	**15,975.7**	**19,307.3**
Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	10,885.4	13,511.6	17,400.8	20,635.8
EBITDA (Rmb mn)	4,951.2	5,237.2	5,909.7	6,757.3
EPS (Rmb) New	**0.35**	**0.40**	**0.85**	**1.27**
EPS (Rmb) Old	0.35	0.50	0.96	1.54
P/E (X)	71.1	67.7	31.4	21.0
P/B (X)	1.8	2.0	2.0	1.9
Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.5	1.2	1.7
CROCI (%)	11.3	9.8	9.6	9.7

	9/26	12/26E	3/27E	6/27E
EPS (Rmb)	0.10	0.17	0.15	0.21

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 26 Oct 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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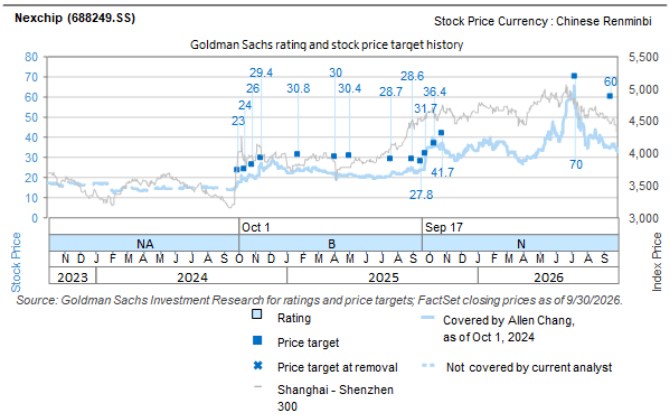
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Target price history table(s)
Nexchip (688249.SS)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
21-Oct-26	51.40	27.35
16-Sep-26	60.00	35.67
10-Jul-26	70.00	54.12
30-Oct-25	41.70	36.03
14-Oct-25	36.40	36.33
26-Sep-25	31.70	32.90
17-Sep-25	27.80	23.82
31-Aug-25	28.60	24.28
22-Jul-25	28.70	21.80
02-May-25	30.40	21.32
06-Apr-25	30.00	21.91
25-Jan-25	30.80	24.18
15-Nov-24	29.40	25.16
30-Oct-24	26.00	20.01
13-Oct-24	24.00	19.42
02-Oct-24	23.00	17.51

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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